



MOTION on NOTICE

Submitted at the Regular Park Board Meeting on May 25, 2026

Waiving 2026 Vancouver Park Board Fees for Italian Day on The Drive

SUBMITTED BY: Commissioner Jensen

WHEREAS

1. Italian Day on The Drive is one of Vancouver's largest free cultural festivals, attracting hundreds of thousands of attendees annually to Vancouver's historic Little Italy along Commercial Drive; and
2. Italian Day is a free, all-ages event powered by volunteers, sponsors, local merchants, artists, performers, and community organizations, and has become one of Vancouver's signature cultural celebrations since its revival in 2010; and
3. Festival organizers have identified extraordinary financial pressures affecting the 2026 festival season, including rising costs associated with public safety, sanitation, insurance, and event operations, as well as the loss of sponsorship revenue related to FIFA World Cup street banner restrictions and changes to provincial grant funding priorities; and
4. The Vancouver Park Board has historically supported festivals, cultural celebrations, and community events that contribute to vibrant public spaces and strengthen neighbourhood identity and inclusion; and
5. Waiving applicable Vancouver Park Board fees for the 2026 Italian Day festival would provide meaningful support to organizers while helping ensure the continued success and accessibility of this important community event;

THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT The Vancouver Board of Parks and Recreation direct staff to waive all applicable Vancouver Park Board fees associated with the 2026 Italian Day on The Drive festival, including event-related permit and park use fees where operationally feasible.